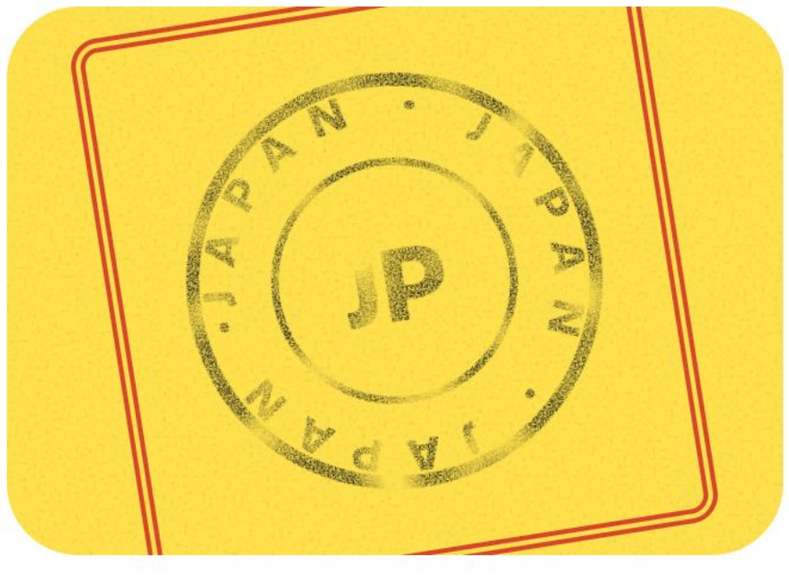
Japan's 2026 rules for paying agencies





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What changed in 2026



No notes

Promissory notes banned as payment

Negotiate

No one-sided pricing, clients must discuss

Wider scope

Employee numbers now count too

Fees

Transfer fees can’t go to the supplier

Source: 中小受託取引適正化法 · 公正取引委員会 · 中小企業...

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Numbers to know



60 days

Maximum from receiving the work to payment

300

Employee threshold for manufacturing-type work

100

Employee threshold for services and content

Source: 公正取引委員会 取適法の概要

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Rate reviews now get heard

If a studio asks to discuss price, the client has to engage.

Silence and a fixed rate no longer works.

Supplier asks

↓

Client discusses

↓

Agreed rate



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Japan now protects the small studio by law.

Taking a Western brand into Japan, Korea or wider APAC?

Give me a shout

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